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Dynamic Network Configuration for Printers

Abstract

A method in a server includes: storing, at the server, a configuration update definition including (i) criteria, and (ii) configuration update payload data; obtaining at the server, from a computing device having a connection to a wireless local area network (WLAN), a parameter of the connection; determining whether the parameter satisfies the criteria of the configuration update definition; and in response to determining that the parameter satisfies the criteria, transmitting the configuration update payload data to the computing device.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/752,707, filed on Jun. 24, 2024, which is a divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/885,060, filed on Aug. 10, 2022, each of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Media processing devices such as desktop label printers, e.g., for home or small business use, may rely on wireless network connections, e.g., to wireless local area networks (WLANs). Various factors can affect the quality of such network connections, including for example the physical environment in which the printer is deployed, and/or certain characteristics of the devices implementing the WLAN. Suboptimal connection quality can lead to reduced and/or interrupted printing performance, consumption of technical support resources and/or personnel, customer complaints, or the like.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] The accompanying figures, where like reference numerals refer to identical or functionally similar elements throughout the separate views, together with the detailed description below, are incorporated in and form part of the specification, and serve to further illustrate embodiments of concepts that include the claimed invention, and explain various principles and advantages of those embodiments.

[0004] FIG. 1 is a diagram of a system for dynamic network configuration for media processing devices.

[0005] FIG. 2 is a diagram of certain internal components of a media processing device, and a server, from the system of FIG. 1.

[0006] FIG. 3 is a flowchart of a method of dynamic network configuration for media processing devices.

[0007] FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating a further example performance of blocks 305 and 310 of the method of FIG. 3.

[0008] FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example performance of blocks 315 and 320 of the method of FIG. 3.

[0009] FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating an example performance of block 330 of the method of FIG. 3.

[0010] Skilled artisans will appreciate that elements in the figures are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some of the elements in the figures may be exaggerated relative to other elements to help to improve understanding of embodiments of the present invention.

[0011] The apparatus and method components have been represented where appropriate by conventional symbols in the drawings, showing only those specific details that are pertinent to understanding the embodiments of the present invention so as not to obscure the disclosure with details that will be readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of the

description herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0012] Examples disclosed herein are directed to a method in a server, comprising: storing, at the server, a configuration update definition including (i) trigger criteria, and (ii) configuration update payload data; obtaining at the server, from a computing device having a connection to a wireless local area network (WLAN), a parameter of the connection; determining whether the parameter satisfies the trigger criteria of the configuration update definition; and in response to determining that the parameter satisfies the trigger criteria, transmitting the configuration update payload data to the computing device.

[0013] Additional examples disclosed herein are directed to a server, comprising: a memory storing a configuration update definition including (i) trigger criteria, and (ii) configuration update payload data; and a processor configured to: obtain, from a computing device having a connection to a wireless local area network (WLAN), a parameter of the connection; determine whether the parameter satisfies the trigger criteria of the configuration update definition; and in response to determining that the parameter satisfies the trigger criteria, transmit the configuration update payload data to the computing device.

[0014] Further examples disclosed herein are directed to a printer, comprising: a housing configured to receive a supply of print media; a print head supported by the housing; a wireless communications interface supported by the housing; a memory supported by the housing, storing a plurality of network configuration settings; and a processor supported by the housing, the processor configured to: establish a connection with a wireless local area network (WLAN); collect a plurality of connection parameters associated with the connection; transmit the connection parameters to a server; receive an update configuration command from the server, based on the transmitted connection parameters; and modify at least one of the network configuration settings according to the update configuration command.

[0015] FIG. 1 illustrates a system **100** for dynamic network configuration in media processing devices such as printers. The system **100** thus includes at least one media processing device. In the illustrated example, the system **100** includes three example media processing devices **104-1**, **104-2**, and **104-3** (collectively referred to as media processing devices **104**, and generically as a media processing device **104**; similar nomenclature may be used for other components herein for which multiple instances are shown). The media processing devices **104** in this example are printers, such as desktop label printers, and are therefore also referred to as printers **104**. In other examples, the media processing devices **104** can include radio frequency identification (RFID) tag writing functionality instead of or in addition to printing functionality. In further examples, the media processing devices **104** can be other computing devices, such as a mobile computers, barcode scanners, and the like.

[0016] Each printer **104** includes a housing **108** (the housing **108-1** of the printer **104-1** being shown in FIG. 1) supporting a media supply, such as a roll of labels, receipt paper, or the like. Indicia are applied to the media via thermal printing, direct thermal printing, or the like. The media is then dispensed, e.g. from an outlet slot **112** defined in the housing **108**.

[0017] Each printer **104** can receive instructions to execute a print job, alter configuration settings, or the like, via an internal wireless network interface. The printer **104** can be configured, via the wireless network interface, to establish a connection with a network **116**, such as a wireless local area network (WLAN), e.g., a WiFi network. FIG. 1 illustrates two distinct networks **116-1** and **116-2**, which can be deployed in different locations (e.g., different residences or businesses) in which subsets of the printers **104** are deployed. Each network **116** is implemented by at least one (and in some cases, more than one) access point (AP), with which printers **104** can communicate to establish a connection with the relevant network **116**.

[0018] A variety of factors can affect the wireless connection between a printer **104** and a network **116**. For example, the physical distance between the printer **104** and the access point to which the

printer **104** is connected, and/or the presence of obstacles such as walls between the printer **104** and the access point can lead to increased latency (e.g., due to transmission failures leading to packet retransmissions), loss of the connection, weak received signal strength at either or both of the printer **104** and the access point, and the like. In other examples, certain access points may be prone to suboptimal performance under certain conditions, such as when a printer **104** makes use of a particular network configuration setting.

[0019] Scenarios such as those mentioned above can impede the performance of the printers **104**, e.g., by interrupting print operations or slowing such operations. Operators of the printers **104**, however, may have insufficient access to network parameters and/or technical expertise to diagnose or resolve connectivity issues with a printer **104**. Performance problems may therefore go unresolved, or may necessitate contact with technical support staff (e.g., provided by a manufacturer of the printers **104**).

[0020] The system **100** also includes a server **120**, configured to collect various network parameters from the printers **104**, for processing and/or storage in a central repository **124**. In some examples, the server **120** also routes print jobs to the printers **104**, e.g., upon receiving such print jobs from operator computing devices (e.g., mobile computers or the like). The printers **104**, in other words, may be configured to establish connections with the server **120** for regular operation, and such connections can then also be used for the collection of network parameters.

[0021] As will be discussed below in greater detail, the server **120** is configured to collect network parameters from the printers **104** as noted above, and can aggregate the network parameters to generate reports thereof and/or detect trends therein. Such processing of the collected network parameters enables the server **120** to obtain, either automatically or as input data from an operator of the server **120**, configuration update definitions. Each configuration update definition includes one or more criteria and configuration update payload data. In general, when the criteria are satisfied by the network parameters collected from a given printer **104**, the payload data is provided to that printer **104**. The nature of the criteria and the payload data vary, as discussed below. For instance, the criteria can specify certain conditions recognized (e.g., from aggregated network parameters from a plurality of printers **104**) as being associated with suboptimal wireless connectivity. The payload data can therefore include data that dynamically reconfigures the relevant printer **104** to improve wireless connectivity. The payload data can therefore include network configuration settings, a firmware upgrade, or the like.

[0022] Turning to FIG. **2**, certain internal components of an example printer **104** are shown. Each printer **104** in the system **100** includes those components, although the printers **104** can have distinct form factors, versions of each component, and the like.

[0023] The printer **104** as shown in FIG. **2** includes a processor **200** such as a central processing unit (CPU) and/or graphics processing unit (GPU), application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or the like, communicatively coupled with a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium such as a memory **204**, e.g., a combination of volatile memory elements (e.g., random access memory (RAM)) and non-volatile memory elements (e.g., flash memory or the like). The memory **204** stores a plurality of computer-readable instructions in the form of applications, including in the illustrated example a firmware application **208** whose execution by the processor **200** configures the printer **104** to transmit network parameters to the server **120**, and to receive and apply configuration updates from the server **120**. Execution of the application **208**, or other applications (not shown) stored in the memory **204**, can also configure the printer **104** to execute print jobs, establish connections with networks **116**, and the like.

[0024] The printer **104** also includes a communications interface **212**, enabling the printer **104** to establish connections with WLANs, such as the networks **116** shown in FIG. **1**. The communications interface **212** can therefore include any suitable combination of transceivers, antenna elements, and corresponding control hardware enabling communications with the networks **116**.

[0025] The printer **104** also includes, in this example, a print head **216** controllable to apply indicia to the media from the supply. The print head **216** can include a thermal print head, e.g. with an array of independently controllable thermal elements to activate pigment in the media, and/or to transfer pigment from a ribbon within the housing **108** to the media. In other examples, the print head **216** can employ impression technologies other than thermal printing.

[0026] Also shown in FIG. **2** are certain internal components of the server **120**. The server **120** includes a processor **200** such as a CPU and/or GPU, communicatively coupled with a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium such as a memory **254**. The memory **254** stores the repository **124** mentioned in connection with FIG. **1**, as well as instructions executable by the processor **250**, e.g., in the form of an application **258**, to perform functionality related to the collection and processing of network parameters from the printers **104**, and the dynamic reconfiguration of the printers **104** based on the configuration update definitions mentioned above.

[0027] The server **120** also includes a communications interface **262**, including hardware and software components enabling the server **120** to communicate with other computing devices via one or more networks. The components of the server **120** can be deployed in an enclosure, or in a plurality of physically distributed enclosures (e.g., as a cloud-based computing system).

[0028] Turning to FIG. **3**, a method **300** of dynamically updating printer network configurations is illustrated. The method **300** is described below in conjunction with its example performance in the system **100**. As indicated in FIG. **3**, certain blocks of the method **300** are performed by the printers **104**, while other blocks of the method **300** are performed by the server **120**.

[0029] At block **305**, the printer **104** is configured to collect and send network connection parameters to the server **120**. Each printer **104**, for example, can be configured to monitor various parameters in response to establishing a connection with a network **116**. Those parameters can be used by the communications interface **212** to assess the state of the connection, e.g., to determine whether to attempt to roam to a different access point in the network **116**, or the like. A wide variety of connection parameters can be collected by the printer **104**. Examples of connection parameters include one or more samples of received signal strength indicator (RSSI) corresponding to signals received from an access point, and/or one or more samples of signal to noise ratio (SNR) corresponding to signals received from an access point. Further examples of such parameters include parameters derived from the RSSI and SNR measurements mentioned above, such as a count of RSSI samples (e.g., over a predetermined time period such as an hour, a day, or the like) that fell below a threshold, such as a roam scan trigger threshold.

[0030] Additional examples of reported connection parameters include a count of failed connection attempts over a predetermined period of time, a count of pack retransmissions over a predetermined period of time, and the like.

[0031] Still further examples of parameters collected by the printer **104** include an identifier of the access point with which the printer **104** is connected. The identifier can include a media access control (MAC) address of the access point, or a portion thereof such as the original equipment identifier (OUI) indicating the manufacturer of the access point (generally a leading subset of octets of the MAC address). The parameters can further include network configuration settings employed at the printer **104** to establish the connection, such as roam scan trigger thresholds (e.g., expressed as an RSSI threshold), whether certain features are enabled or disabled, and the like. An example of such features is protected management frames (PMF), activation of which configures the printer **104** to encrypt management frames (which are otherwise generally unencrypted). A wide variety of other example features will also now occur to those skilled in the art.

[0032] The printer **104** can store scheduling and reporting settings in the memory **204**, e.g., in a dedicated portion of the firmware **208** or other application executed at the printer **104**. Such settings can determine, for example, how frequently the printer **104** reports connection parameters to the server **120** (e.g., daily, weekly, or the like), as well as which parameters are to be reported.

[0033] FIG. **4** illustrates the transmission of connection parameters by the printers **104-1** and **104-2**

to the server **120**, in respective reporting messages **400-1** and **400-2**. The content of the reporting messages **400** can be structured according to a predetermined application programming interface (API) employed by the server **120** and the printers **104** to exchange data. For example, each message **400** can include a label “Network_Report” (or any other suitable indicator) that marks the message **400** as containing connection parameters.

[0034] As shown in FIG. 4, each reporting message **400** includes an identifier of the printer **104** itself (e.g., **104-1** or **104-2**), as well as a set of connection parameters. In this example, the parameters include a MAC address (shortened for this illustration) of the access point in the network **116-1** with which the printers **104** are connected (e.g., “12:34:56:78”). The reported parameters also include a count (“Low_RSSI”), over a predetermined time period (e.g., one day, although other time periods can also be employed), of instances in which the RSSI measured from signals from the access point fell below a threshold. The threshold itself may also be reported, e.g., in the form of an RSSI threshold below which the printer **104** initiates a scanning operation to seek other access points (that is, a roam scan trigger threshold, “Roam_Thresh”).

[0035] Returning to FIG. 3, in some examples, as shown in FIG. 4, the reporting of network connection parameters at block **305** can be initiated automatically by the printers **104**. In other examples, the reporting of network connection parameters can be initiated by the server **120**. That is, the server **120** can send a request for connection parameters according to the above-mentioned API, e.g., identifying which specific parameters are to be reported. In further examples, the server **120** can send the scheduling and reporting settings mentioned above to the printers **104**, to configure the timing and content of future reporting messages **400** from the printers **104**.

[0036] Whether the server **120** receives the connection parameters passively, or expressly requests the parameters from the printers **104**, at block **310** the server **120** therefore receives the connection parameters from one or more printers **104**. In some examples, connection parameters are received from all printers **104**, although not necessarily simultaneously.

[0037] At block **315**, the server **120** is configured to store the connection parameters received from the printer(s) **104** at block **310**. The server **120** can store the parameters in the repository, e.g., in association with a unique identifier of the corresponding printer **104**. In some examples, the server **120** can process the received parameters prior to storage in the repository, e.g., to anonymize certain parameters. For example, turning to FIG. 5, two example records **500-1** and **500-2** are shown in the repository following respective performances of block **315** to store the parameters contained in the messages **400-1** and **400-2** from FIG. 4.

[0038] In particular, the record **500-1** corresponds to the printer **104-1**, and includes the parameters in the message **400-1** with the exception of the access point MAC address. In the illustrated example, the server **120** stores the OUI (e.g., the first half of the MAC address) and may discard the remainder of the access point MAC address. In addition, the server **120** can derive additional parameters from those reported by the printers **104**. For example, the records **500-1** and **500-2** each contain a count (“No. APs”) of distinct access points that the printers **104-1** and **104-2** have reported connections with over a predetermined time period (e.g., one week, although various other time periods are also contemplated).

[0039] Returning to FIG. 3, in some examples, at block **315** the server **120** can also generate and store aggregated connection parameters from the individual sets of parameters reported by the printers **104**. For example, in addition to the printer-specific records **500**, the server **120** can generate and store one or more aggregated records containing parameters derived from data reported by a plurality of printers **104**. An example aggregated record can include an OUI identifying a particular access point manufacturer, and a count, for that OUI across all the printers **104** in the system **100** with one or more settings enabled, of reported failed connection attempts. For example, such an aggregated record to include a count of reported failed connection attempts across all printers **104** with PMF enabled, for a given OUI. A wide variety of other aggregated data will now also occur to those skilled in the art. Such aggregated records can be used to identify

trends in the population of printers **104** in the system **100**, such as a particular access point manufacturer having a PMF implementation that leads to unstable connections (and therefore numerous connection failures).

[0040] The server **120** can be configured to transmit, display, or otherwise output, the printer-specific parameters and/or the aggregated parameters mentioned above, e.g., for viewing and processing by an operator of the server **120**. At block **320**, the server **120** can optionally (as indicated by the dashed outline of block **320**) receive one or more configuration update definitions for storage in the memory **254**. The configuration update definitions can be received as input data from an operator of the server **120**, for example.

[0041] Each configuration update definition defines one or more criteria as well as payload data. In general, when reported parameters from a given printer **104** satisfy the criteria of a configuration update definition, the server **120** is configured to send the payload data of that configuration update definition to the relevant printer **104**. As will be discussed below, the deployment of payload data enables the server **120** to dynamically reconfigure a printer **104**, e.g., by altering network connection settings at the printer **104** to optimize wireless connectivity performance at the printer **104**, mitigate observed connectivity problems at the printer **104**, or the like.

[0042] At block **325**, the server **120** is configured to determine, for at least one of the printers **104**, whether the reported connection parameters from block **310** satisfy the criteria of any stored configuration update definitions.

[0043] FIG. **5** illustrates an example configuration update definition **504**, including at least one criterion **508**, and corresponding configuration update payload data **512**. In the illustrated example, the criteria **508** include two criteria, both of which must be satisfied in order for the determination at block **325** to be affirmative (as indicated by the boolean operator “AND” separating the criteria). The criteria in the illustrated example include a first criterion requiring that a reported number of low-RSSI events exceed ten, and a second criterion requiring that a count of access points to which the printer **104** has reported connections with be equal to one.

[0044] The criteria **508** set out above seek to identify printers **104** that are within range of only a single access point, e.g., whether because the network **116** is a small-scale network implemented by a single access point, or because the printer **104** is in a location that places it out of range of any other access points. The criteria **508** further seek to identify printers that have reported numerous roam scan trigger events, which cause the printers **104** to initiate roam scan operations that may increase congestion on the network **116**, interrupt regular operations of the printers **104**, increase battery drain if the printers **104** are battery-powered, and the like. The combination of the two illustrated criteria, therefore, seeks to identify printers **104** that are likely attempting to roam but failing to do so because no other access points are available. The payload data **512** therefore applies a reduction in the roam trigger threshold (e.g., 30% in this example, although a wide variety of other fractional or absolute reductions, or explicit values, can be applied). The payload data **512**, in other words, can be used to dynamically alter the roam trigger threshold at such printers **104**, to reduce the frequency of ineffective roam attempts at the printers **104**.

[0045] At block **325**, therefore, the server **120** can compare the reported parameters from each printer **104** to each available configuration update definition. In other words, the reported parameters from a given printer **104** can satisfy as few as zero criteria in some cases, but may satisfy the criteria of multiple definitions in other cases.

[0046] When the determination at block **325** is negative, the server **120** returns to block **310**, to continue collecting and processing reported connection parameters as described above. When the determination at block **325** is affirmative, however, the server **120** proceeds to block **330**. At block **330**, the server **120** is configured to send a configuration update command to the relevant printer(s) **104**. The configuration update command contains the payload data **512** of the configuration update definition satisfied by the reported parameters of the relevant printer **104**.

[0047] For example, as shown in FIG. **5**, the reported parameters of the printer **104-2** satisfy the

criteria **508** of the definition **504**. Specifically, the printer **104-2** reported forty-eight low-RSSI events (exceeding the threshold of ten in the criteria **508**), and has reported only one access point. Therefore, at block **330** the server **120** is configured to generate and send an update command to the printer **104-2**, containing the payload data **512** (or data derived from the payload data **512**). As shown in FIG. **6**, for example, the server **120** can send a command **600** according to the previously mentioned API, including a label such as “Update_Command” and an updated setting based on the payload data **512**. In the illustrated example, the command **600** includes a setting update to the roam trigger threshold, decreasing the previous threshold of ten (as seen in FIG. **4**) by 30% to seven.

[0048] Returning to FIG. **3**, at block **335** the printer **104-2** is configured to determine, after sending the network parameters to the server **120** at block **305**, whether any update commands have been received. When the determination at block **335** is negative, the printers **104** can continue reporting connection parameters and awaiting update commands. In the example shown in FIG. **6**, the determination at block **335** is affirmative for the printer **104-2**, and the printer **104-2** thus proceeds to block **340**. At block **340**, the printer **104-2** is configured to update the relevant setting in the memory **204**, according to the command **600**. The printer **104-2** then returns to block **305**, to continue reporting connection parameters.

[0049] The performance of the method **300** therefore enables the dynamic reconfiguration of the printers **104** by the server **120**, which may allow the system **100** to proactively mitigate network connectivity issues before the operators of the printers **104** perceive such issues. Connectivity at the printers **104** may therefore be improved, and the consumption of technical support resources at a manufacturer of the printers **104**, or other supporting entity, may be reduced.

[0050] A wide variety of other example configuration update definitions are also contemplated, beyond the specific example set out above. For example, a further definition can include criteria to select printers **104** connected to access points from a particular manufacturer (i.e., with a specific OUI), and with a specific setting (such as PMF) enabled. The corresponding payload can include a command to disable PMF, e.g., if it is observed that enabling PMF causes connection failures for printers connected to access points from the identified manufacturer.

[0051] The server **120** can also implement various auxiliary functions related to the collection and processing of connection parameters. For example, certain configuration update definitions can include payloads that, in addition to or instead of modifications to configuration settings, cause the server **120** to generate notifications. The server **120** can store account identifiers and/or device identifiers corresponding to computing devices associated with operators of the printers **104**. Thus, for example, if a printer **104** exhibits frequent dropped connections and/or high latency, as well as frequent low-RSSI events, the server **120** can be configured to generate a notification to one or more associated computing devices, e.g., suggesting that the printer **104** be re-located closer to an access point.

[0052] More generally, the payload data in any given configuration update definition can include any combination of network configuration settings, firmware update commands (or updated firmware itself), notifications, and the like.

[0053] In the foregoing specification, specific embodiments have been described. However, one of ordinary skill in the art appreciates that various modifications and changes can be made without departing from the scope of the invention as set forth in the claims below. Accordingly, the specification and figures are to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense, and all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of present teachings.

[0054] The benefits, advantages, solutions to problems, and any element(s) that may cause any benefit, advantage, or solution to occur or become more pronounced are not to be construed as a critical, required, or essential features or elements of any or all the claims. The invention is defined solely by the appended claims including any amendments made during the pendency of this application and all equivalents of those claims as issued.

[0055] Moreover in this document, relational terms such as first and second, top and bottom, and the like may be used solely to distinguish one entity or action from another entity or action without necessarily requiring or implying any actual such relationship or order between such entities or actions. The terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “has,” “having,” “includes,” “including,” “contains,” “containing” or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion, such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises, has, includes, contains a list of elements does not include only those elements but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such process, method, article, or apparatus. An element preceded by “comprises . . . a”, “has . . . a”, “includes . . . a”, “contains . . . a” does not, without more constraints, preclude the existence of additional identical elements in the process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises, has, includes, contains the element. The terms “a” and “an” are defined as one or more unless explicitly stated otherwise herein. The terms “substantially”, “essentially”, “approximately”, “about” or any other version thereof, are defined as being close to as understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, and in one non-limiting embodiment the term is defined to be within 10%, in another embodiment within 5%, in another embodiment within 1% and in another embodiment within 0.5%. The term “coupled” as used herein is defined as connected, although not necessarily directly and not necessarily mechanically. A device or structure that is “configured” in a certain way is configured in at least that way, but may also be configured in ways that are not listed.

[0056] Certain expressions may be employed herein to list combinations of elements. Examples of such expressions include: “at least one of A, B, and C”; “one or more of A, B, and C”; “at least one of A, B, or C”; “one or more of A, B, or C”. Unless expressly indicated otherwise, the above expressions encompass any combination of A and/or B and/or C.

[0057] It will be appreciated that some embodiments may be comprised of one or more specialized processors (or “processing devices”) such as microprocessors, digital signal processors, customized processors and field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) and unique stored program instructions (including both software and firmware) that control the one or more processors to implement, in conjunction with certain non-processor circuits, some, most, or all of the functions of the method and/or apparatus described herein. Alternatively, some or all functions could be implemented by a state machine that has no stored program instructions, or in one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), in which each function or some combinations of certain of the functions are implemented as custom logic. Of course, a combination of the two approaches could be used.

[0058] Moreover, an embodiment can be implemented as a computer-readable storage medium having computer readable code stored thereon for programming a computer (e.g., comprising a processor) to perform a method as described and claimed herein. Examples of such computer-readable storage mediums include, but are not limited to, a hard disk, a CD-ROM, an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, a ROM (Read Only Memory), a PROM (Programmable Read Only Memory), an EPROM (Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory), an EEPROM (Electrically Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory) and a Flash memory. Further, it is expected that one of ordinary skill, notwithstanding possibly significant effort and many design choices motivated by, for example, available time, current technology, and economic considerations, when guided by the concepts and principles disclosed herein will be readily capable of generating such software instructions and programs and ICs with minimal experimentation.

[0059] The Abstract of the Disclosure is provided to allow the reader to quickly ascertain the nature of the technical disclosure. It is submitted with the understanding that it will not be used to interpret or limit the scope or meaning of the claims. In addition, in the foregoing Detailed Description, it can be seen that various features are grouped together in various embodiments for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed embodiments require more features than are expressly

recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive subject matter lies in less than all features of a single disclosed embodiment. Thus the following claims are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description, with each claim standing on its own as a separately claimed subject matter.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: receiving network connection parameters from a plurality of electronic devices, each electronic device configured to establish a connection with a wireless network; generating, aggregated connection data based on the network connection parameters; detecting a trend in the aggregated connection data that is indicative of a network connectivity issue associated with a subset of the plurality of electronic devices; generating a configuration update definition based on the trend, the configuration update definition including criteria and data for altering network configuration settings of the plurality of electronic devices to mitigate the network connectivity issue; identifying a specific electronic device in the plurality of electronic devices that satisfies the criteria; and configuring the specific electronic device with the data for altering network configuration settings in the configuration update definition in response to the network connection parameters of the identified specific electronic device satisfying the criteria.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein obtaining the network connection parameters comprises: transmitting a reporting command to the plurality of electronic devices, the reporting command causing the network connection parameters to be received from the plurality of electronic devices.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the reporting command includes identifiers of a plurality of distinct network connection parameters of the connection.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the parameter of the connection includes at least one of: (i) a received signal strength indicator (RSSI), (ii) a signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) indicator, or (iii) an identifier of an access point of a wireless network.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the identifier of the access point includes an original equipment identifier (OUI).
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the data for altering network configuration settings includes a network configuration setting for the specific electronic device to establish the connection.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the data for altering network configuration settings includes a firmware update for the specific electronic device.
8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving further connection parameters from a plurality of additional electronic devices; and obtaining the configuration update definition based on the connection parameters.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the criteria include at least one of: (i) a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) threshold, (ii) a signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) threshold, or (iii) a target original equipment identifier (OUI).
10. The method of claim 1, wherein analyzing the aggregated connection data further comprises detecting patterns of frequent roam scan operations initiated by the media processing devices due to low RSSI measurements, and identifying those devices as candidates for dynamic roaming adjustments.
11. The method of claim 10, further comprising modifying the data for altering network configuration settings to include dynamic roaming adjustments that configure the specific electronic device to alter roam scan intervals or thresholds to reduce ineffective roaming attempts and increase connectivity stability.
12. A device, comprising: a communications interface; a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing code; a processor configured to execute code stored in the non-transitory computer-readable medium to: receive network connection parameters from a plurality of electronic devices via the communications interface, each electronic device in the plurality of electronic devices configured

to establish a connection with a wireless network; generate, aggregated connection data based on the network connection parameters; detect a trend in the aggregated connection data that is indicative of a network connectivity issue associated with the plurality of electronic devices; generate a configuration update definition based on the trend, the configuration update definition including criteria and data for altering network configuration settings of the plurality of electronic devices to mitigate the network connectivity issue; identify a specific electronic device in the plurality of electronic devices that satisfies the criteria; and configure, via the communications interface, the specific electronic device in with the data for altering network configuration settings in the configuration update definition in response to the network connection parameters of the identified specific electronic device satisfying the criteria.

13. The device of claim 12, wherein the parameter of the connection includes at least one of: (i) a received signal strength indicator (RSSI), (ii) a signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) indicator, or (iii) an identifier of an access point of a wireless network.

14. The device of claim 13, wherein the identifier of the access point includes an original equipment identifier (OUI).

15. The device of claim 12, wherein the data for altering network configuration settings includes a network configuration setting for the specific electronic device to establish the connection.

16. The device of claim 12, wherein the data for altering network configuration settings includes a firmware update for the specific electronic device.

17. The device of claim 12, wherein the criteria include at least one of: (i) a received signal strength indicator (RSSI) threshold, (ii) a signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) threshold, or (iii) a target original equipment identifier (OUI).

18. The device of claim 12, wherein patterns of frequent roam scan operations initiated by the plurality of electronic devices are detected in the aggregated connection data due to low RSSI measurements, and specific electronic device is identified as a candidate for dynamic roaming adjustments.

19. The device of claim 18, further comprising modifying the data for altering network configuration settings to include dynamic roaming adjustments that configure the specific electronic device to alter roam scan intervals or thresholds to reduce ineffective roaming attempts and increase connectivity stability.

20. A method, comprising: receiving network connection parameters from a plurality of electronic devices, the network connection parameters including measurements related to signal strength and network connectivity performance; detecting patterns of frequent roam scan operations and ineffective roaming attempts by a subset of the plurality of electronic devices; generating configuration update definitions for the plurality of electronic devices based on the patterns detected, each configuration update definition comprising criteria and data for adjusting roaming configurations; identifying a specific electronic device in the plurality of electronic devices that satisfies the criteria; and configuring the identified specific electronic device with configuration update commands containing the data for adjusting roaming configurations to change a roaming behavior of the identified specific electronic device by modifying network settings of the identified specific electronic device.

21. The method of claim 20, wherein the network settings include roam scan intervals and thresholds.

22. The method of claim 20, wherein the network connection parameters include at least one of a received signal strength indicator (RSSI), signal to noise ratio (SNR), or a count of roam scan trigger events over a predetermined period.

23. The method of claim 20, further comprising configuring the identified specific electronic device to initiate roam scan operations based on predefined RSSI thresholds, and receiving reports related to the occurrence and frequency of the roam scan operations.

24. The method of claim 20, wherein the criteria includes detecting a pattern of repeated roam scan

operations that fail to connect with alternative access points.

25. The method of claim 20, further comprising adjusting the data for adjusting roaming configurations to include a reduction in roam scan trigger thresholds when the identified specific electronic devices are attempting to roam unsuccessfully due to limited access point availability.

26. The method of claim 20, wherein the configuration update commands further include altering the frequency of roam scan operations to balance connectivity stability and network performance.

27. The method of claim 20, wherein analyzing the received network connection parameters includes aggregating the network connection parameters across the plurality of electronic devices to identify common connectivity issues and changes to roaming behavior.

28. The method of claim 20, further comprising generating notifications when detected roaming patterns indicate a need for physical relocation of the identified specific electronic devices to improve network connectivity.

29. The method of claim 20, wherein the data for adjusting roaming configurations includes instructions for firmware updates that incorporate enhanced algorithms for determining roam scan intervals based on real-time network conditions.

30. A device, comprising: a communications interface; a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing code; a processor configured to execute code stored in the non-transitory computer-readable medium to: receive network connection parameters from a plurality of electronic devices, the network connection parameters including measurements related to signal strength and network connectivity performance; detect patterns of frequent roam scan operations and ineffective roaming attempts by a subset of the plurality of electronic devices; generate configuration update definitions for the plurality of electronic devices based on the patterns detected, each configuration update definition comprising criteria and data for adjusting roaming configurations; identify a specific electronic device in the plurality of electronic devices that satisfies the criteria; and configure the identified specific electronic device with configuration update commands containing the data for adjusting roaming configurations to change a roaming behavior of the identified specific electronic device by modifying network settings of the identified specific electronic device.
